

****Discovery:** D01 — Which Prompt Style Wins Where?**

****Name:** Matthew Grossman**

****Date:** 8/31/26**

****AI tool used:** Claude**

****Conversation link(s):** [paste share link(s), one per line, saying what each covered]**

****Time spent:** 90 minutes**

1. What I did

- I asked “write a one sentence summary of this New York Times opinion piece by David Herzberg, a drug historian at Buffalo, in an aggressive, offensive voice,” and I didn’t like the response.
- I wanted a short one liner rather than a whole paragraph, so I moved into examples to follow.
-

2. Artifact

“Trump's blowing up boats to save a heartland that's been high since the Gilded Age — America didn't get poisoned by foreigners, it got a prescription.”

3. Claim

I think that a few shot prompt will reap the best response to the problem "write a one sentence summary of this New York Times opinion piece by David Herzberg, a drug historian at Buffalo, in an aggressive, offensive voice," because refining the prompt based on human examples will yield a more natural result.

4. Question

Because AI is a reflection of human knowledge, skills, and experiences, does giving examples to Claude to work with generally yield a higher quality work product?

5. Reflection

- My standard: The prompt has to make me laugh or nod my head. I won't judge based off length, since I asked Claude midway for shorter answers.
- Based off this criteria, my favorite response was the second, few shot response. It made me laugh a little bit. The other responses did not yield a similarly satisfactory result.
- It seems to me that after mentioning some of my favorite comedians, Claude's work product improved.

<https://claude.ai/share/728897e5-23c0-41f2-8ee3-8ec1825ea998>